

OREGON CITY COURIER

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STRANGE, STRANGE IDEA

William Jennings Bryan, the person who "quit cold" while a member of the Wilson cabinet, and who has since then suffered a considerable eclipse of his popularity, appears to be in dire and desperate straits to get publicity. His peace voyage to Europe, where he hoped to end the war single-handed, was neatly nipped in the bud by the administration he tried to embarrass; and his still more recent criticism of the President's plans in regard to national defense does not appear to have gotten him anywhere.

And now comes this same Bryan party, and at a speech given somewhere, says that he does not think a national prohibition plank should be put in the 1916 democratic platform.

There is no particular reason for believing that anybody ever intended to put a prohibition plank in the democratic platform—any more than there is likelihood of slipping one in the republican platform. Established political parties have not yet reached that stage where they feel that a semi-alliance with the prohibition party is necessary to strengthen their fences.

Weird politico-personal upshots, like the Bull Moose party, have found it expedient in the past to try and swing on to the end of the prohibition kite; but otherwise the question of prohibition has been left with the prohibition party.

Mr. Bryan, by mentioning the fact that he doesn't think the democratic platform ought to have a prohibition plank, is probably inspired by the double hope that he will gain some publicity and raise an embarrassing situation for the party of which he was for a short time a member. It would appear as if the former sixteen-to-one enthusiast would like to drag in the liquor question where nobody wants to see it. And of course, his "friendship" for the administration would lead him to do this, if possible.

Mr. Bryan, being an avowed prohibitionist personally, and not being so strongly an avowed democrat, may also be planning a little prohi boom for himself, and may hope to drag a portion of the remains of his following away from the administration's banner. However, it is very much to be doubted if his latest flurry will amount to much more than the other flurries he has tried to create since the day when he "quit cold" in an effort to glorify himself and embarrass the man who made him secretary of state. Bryan is dead, politically; and most people know it. One of these days William Jennings himself will discover it; and then we want be burdened with his funny ideas any more.

MORE ABOUT PORTLAND

Writing in the Benton County Courier, a correspondent says that "Portland is trying to drive nails with a sponge," and that the sponge is made up of the aggregate brains of Portland's commercial institutions. The correspondent thinks Portland is long on air and short on action. Maybe he is right.

Last week the Oregonian had an "inspired" story on one of its back and inconspicuous pages to the effect that the western appendix of the Union Pacific system was going to build a direct line over the Cascades to tidewater at Tacoma. The Union Pacific already owns miles of deep water terminal lands in Tacoma, has a costly tunnel constructed under the city so as to be able to reach this terminal land by an economical grade, and has completed surveys of a line from the end of the "North Coast system," at North Yakima, to Tacoma. Several miles of track, in fact, have already been laid on this survey.

When the Union Pacific made these investments in Tacoma it had traffic connections with Portland, just as it has today. But the terminal plans of the road at Tacoma are so gigantic in scope, and so costly as to investment, that Tacoma has never for a moment doubted that the Union Pacific would eventually make Puget Sound its western terminal. It would appear from this that the Union Pacific, after trying out Portland as a terminal, has found it sadly lacking; and that Tacoma is sufficiently advantageous as

a terminal to make it worth while to build an independent line over the mountains to reach tidewater, in spite of the fact that the Union Pacific, through the O. W. R. & N. even now has trackage rights into Tacoma from its Portland terminal.

Railroads are not moved by sentiment, by fool hopes, or by dreams. When a railroad establishes a terminal at a certain place, it does so because of sound business reasons, and because more traffic can be handled at that terminal with economy than at any other point. Hence the decision of the Union Pacific to resume its construction to Tacoma after "trying" Portland for five or six years (during which time its Tacoma investment has lain idle) is a pretty sure indication that the Puget Sound, and not the Columbia river, is the chief commercial artery of the Pacific Northwest.

Maybe Portland's commercial organizations will now wake up, and quit trying to "drive nails with a sponge." Yelling about "Portland's supremacy" and about the alleged depth of the Columbia and Willamette rivers, won't bring any railroads to Portland. Portland must become a manufacturing city if it is to have any future at all; and in order to become that, Portland men and Oregon men must be willing to invest their own money in Portland and in Oregon enterprises. Just as long as Portland and Oregon try to develop themselves on borrowed money, and refuse to put their own capital into their own development, just so long will progress go past Portland's doors; and just so long will transcontinental railroads climb the Cascades to get to Puget Sound.

We don't wonder that the Portland Telegram now prints an alarm clock at the head of its editorial columns, as an emblem. It is time something woke up Portland.

WHY NOT DO IT?

Is there any particular reason why we should not have a "community Christmas" in Clackamas county this year?

Is there any reason why each of the cities in the county should not erect "community Christmas trees," and so spread the festive spirit more generously than heretofore?

A "community Christmas tree" may cost a great deal of money, or it may cost next to nothing at all. There is all sorts of leeway in the proposition, so that the desires of each community may be met. About all that a "community Christmas tree" really requires is a few hours of volunteer work—though the more effort expended in regard to it, the more attractive will the tree be.

The primary requisite is a tree, and in Clackamas county trees are not hard to get. Almost every city has them galore within its limits. With some timber owner to donate the tree, a committee of citizens to haul it to the center of the community and erect it, and with a very little decoration, the "community Christmas tree" can be made a thing of reality that will spread the spirit of Christmas to all beholders. Then, if more is to be made of it, exercises can be held about the tree on Christmas and other festive days of the midwinter holiday season—choral societies can sing carols, a band could play—even a Santa Claus might be procured to give away fruit to the little ones.

The scheme is a simple one, and would add much to the spirit of Christmas. It can be worked anywhere; and wherever it is tried it will be found worth while.

The county seat could have a "community Christmas tree" with more than usual appropriateness. It could erect its street at Seventh and Main streets, and about the base of the emblem of goodwill to all, it could celebrate its new elevator, its new water and its new paving. Doubtless the power company would be glad to volunteer electric decorations for the tree in repayment for the city's efforts to stop the jitneys. And probably there are enough public-spirited organizations in the county seat to provide decorations that would add to the beauty of the tree in the daytime.

Oregon City has several singing organizations and bands that probably could be persuaded to furnish Christmas music on one or two occasions;

and if such were the case, Oregon City would gain much—in mutual good will in community advertising, and in enjoyment of the Christmas spirit. Other towns have Christmas trees—why not Clackamas county towns?

TIMES HAVE CHANGED

At last Friday evening's municipal vaudeville entertainment, when the city council met in special session, Mr. Henry M. Templeton, the man who made Fifth street famous, and who admits he is Oregon City's only honest councilman, rose right up in meeting and asked the city engineer if the specifications of the Fallsview steps hadn't been generously disregarded when the steps were constructed. Councilman Andrews and the city engineer assured Mr. Templeton that the Fallsview steps had been built according to specifications exactly, and wanted to know what had aroused the keen suspicions of Mr. Templeton.

Mr. Templeton replied that he had heard that the specifications had not been followed, and intimated that he was on the verge of unearthing some vast and horrid plot.

How times have changed. How remarkable it seems to have Mr. Templeton smelling rodents upon the desert atmosphere. How weird it is to have Mr. Templeton posing as the astute watchdog of municipal honesty. Just think, he "heard" that there was something fishy about the Fallsview steps, and he wanted to know about it.

How times have changed. Mr. Templeton now is on the alert to find irregularity in city work—yet it was not so many months ago, when the paving of Fifth street was a most absorbing mystery of the municipality, that Mr. Templeton was sitting tight and not saying a word. At the time

and the measures that will be passed, will have just as much to do with you as they will have effect upon the men of this community. You have just as much at stake, you have just as much interest in your city, as have the men. And it is only fair and right that you should go to the polls and vote, so that your opinion in regard to the city's management may be recorded. And besides that, there are special reasons this election why you, the women of Oregon City, should be fully represented at the polls. What these reasons are we do not need to outline here—you know them.

If it rains or snows or storms election day, do not let this keep you from the polls. Make it a point to go and vote, even if it is an inconvenience to yourself. Casting your ballot is not only a duty of citizenship; it is the privilege of the free, Western American woman. Be sure that you avail yourself of this privilege, and be sure, also, that you do your duty to your city and to its people.

MORE ABOUT WORMS

There has been considerable in some of the papers recently about the worm that lost Oregon the first prize on apples at the San Francisco fair. Oregon apple growers don't seem to take kindly to the decision, and are trying to say that this one worm should not have disqualified them. Probably the worm wasn't all that cost Oregon the apple prize; but as long as the worm was there it was a fine alibi, and was so used.

A new light has now been shed on Oregon apples by the United States which cannot be accused of "playing favorites." Thanksgiving day our Uncle Samuel gave his soldiers, sailors and marines a special Thanksgiv-

THE NEW WAY

Over in Cosmopolis, Washington, they are going to have a city election shortly, and a mayor is to be selected. Nobody has the slightest idea whom the mayor will be, for there are no candidates for the office, and the time for filing nominations has passed. Voters will be expected to write upon the ballots the name of the person whom they would like to elect mayor—and if a handful of electors happen to write the same name, that man will be duly elected.

Cosmopolis appears to take even less interest in its mayor than does Oregon City, where only two candidates have appeared, and where both are running on approximately the same platform. There will be blank spaces on the Oregon City ballots, too—and perhaps some group of citizens will get together and write in the name of some other person than the candidates already in nomination; both of whom protest that they will make no campaign for the office.

It used to be that there was a battle royal for the office of mayor—everywhere. But of late the public interest in mayors seems to have fallen off, until in Oregon City we are to have no campaign and in Cosmopolis no candidates. Perhaps this changed condition is a forerunner of new days to come, when candidates will not throw their hats into the ring at all, and when offices will be filled entirely at the will of the voter, by writing in names upon the ballot. This would be true democracy, true rule of the people—and it would be extremely interesting to see how it would work.

The Courier has a full line of Legal Blanks for sale. If you are in need of Legal Blanks you will find that it will pay you to come to the Courier.

Victrola



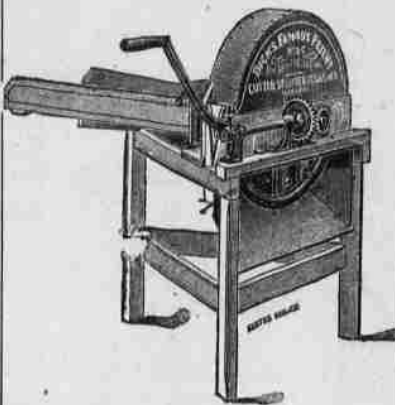
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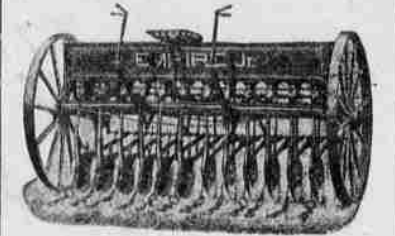
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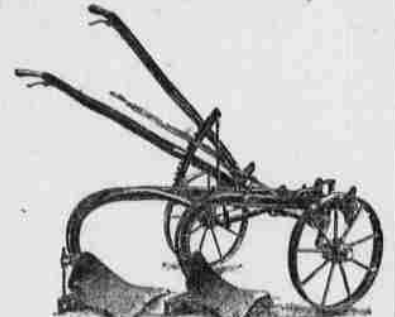
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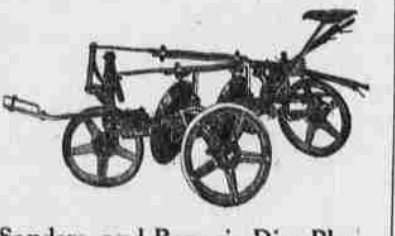
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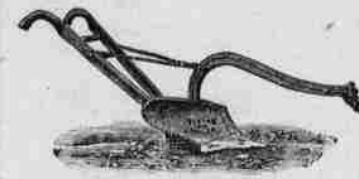
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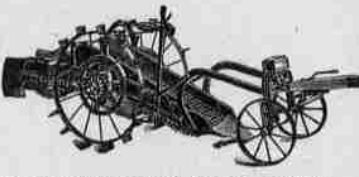
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CHOO CHOO; ALL ABOARD
Courier Editorial Moves Writer to Indulge in Verbal Fits

Editor, Courier: In your Thanksgiving paper, which I read while making a trip from Canby to Molalla over the "modern" branch of the Southern Pacific, you had an editorial on our western supremacy regarding railroads. Maybe you knew what you were talking about, but outside of the last paragraph I don't think you did. You don't mind this frankness, do you?

I am a traveling salesman, and I know something about railroads, both the western ones and the eastern ones. And the only "supremacy" I have found in the west is that the lines are longer and the stations further apart. I suppose it is wonderful that the western railroads handle the traffic that they do over single-track lines, but that phase of the matter has never been impressed upon me. Some other phases have.

For instance, I was traveling over a western road that had one terminal at the tidewater of the Pacific and the other at the Missouri river transfer some years ago. I was on a "limited train"—probably so called because it was limited as to the number of water tanks at which it stopped. One of these stops was at an Eastern Washington town, and just as we finished our quarter-of-an-hour wait there for orders and started to pull out, a freight train consisting of two cars of eggs and sixteen cars of railroad iron came down the grade and climbed into us.

After the jar was over we went up to the head of the train and looked at the two locomotives that had been welded into one solid mass of junk that blocked the track absolutely, and then we listened to the engineer of the freight train explain how it happened.

"I had orders to pass you at the siding at the top of the hill," he said, "but I was low on water, and there was no tank there. I thought I could get down here and fill up before you started."

And because of the "supremacy" of that engineer's thought we stayed in that Eastern Washington town all day, while the hot sun scrambled the eggs in those two busted freight cars, and a wrecking crane started at the other end of the freight and threw the cars off the track one at a time so that the "limited" could be pushed through with an engine that came up behind us on the next following train, six hours later. I never saw anything like that happen in the east.

At another time I was on a coast train going from Seattle to northern points, and near Mukletoe we got caught between two mud slides. The mud slide from the side of a hill that bordered the sound right down into the salt water, and there wasn't any place to build a track around the mud to a relief train. In the east they'd have found a way to get around the slide, I think.

Maybe we've got lots of "supremacy" in our railroads out here, but it takes an editor to find it out, I guess.

TIED DRUMMER.
(Editor's note: Every time we travel on the Great Northern we get a grouch, too. But just the same we maintain that there are railroads in the West that have a vast supremacy over the cute little lines in the East.)

High school students who cannot yet come to the University because of finances often enroll, as do school-teachers who want to prepare for examinations for higher certificates. Many a human interest touch is contained in the letters received:

"We have a boy who would like some more education but can't be spared from home just at present," writes an Oregon woman.

"Please pardon my envelope. I would have to ride ten miles to get another. I am so glad you didn't seal yours so I could use it," writes a Crook county girl.

A man who holds down a homestead near Sheridan, Oregon, wishes to utilize his spare time in the best possible manner, and asks for courses and prices, "which are an important item," he says, "not knowing no correspondence study fees are charged, beyond a postage fee."

Housewives sometimes enroll, "to avoid stagnation," as one of them put it, and on young farmer enrolled in an "Introduction to Philosophy" course.

FILMS TO ADVERTISE WHAT GOVERNMENT IS DOING FOR FINNY TRIBES

The work that the United States Bureau of Fisheries is doing in the interest of the fishing industry of the country is soon to be illustrated by the use of motion pictures. In connection with its fish-cultural operations, the Bureau of Fisheries has secured temporarily the services of an expert operator, who has been assigned to duty on the upper Mississippi river, to take views of the rescue operations and the activities in connection with the propagation of the fresh-water mussel.

The film maker will later go to the Great Lakes to take views illustrating the whitefish and lake-trout operations. On the completion of this duty he will be assigned to other fields.

The entire work of the Division of Fish Culture of the Bureau of Fisheries will be fully illustrated when the motion-picture tour is completed, and the results will be available for exhibition wherever there is an interest in this branch of the work of the Department of Commerce.

"Printing with a punch"—at the Courier.

MRS. SLACK'S LETTER
To Mothers of Delicate Children

Palmyra, Pa.—"My little girl had a chronic cough and was so thin you could count her ribs and she had no appetite. Nothing we gave her seemed to help her, until one day Mrs. Neibert asked me to try Vinol, and now she is hungry all the time. Her cough is gone, she is stouter and has a more healthy color. I wish every mother who has a delicate child would try Vinol."

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The World Owes Every Man A Living

But there is no delivery system to bring it to his door. He's got to go after it early and often, and elbow his way through the crowd that gets there first. A crust is better than no bread, so a little saved is better than nothing. Open an account at this bank now, and add to it when able.

The Bank of Oregon City
Oldest Bank in Clackamas County

TO THE LADIES

Men are respectfully informed right now that this editorial is not for them. So if they are real nice and polite, they will read no further; but will at once pass this issue of the Courier to the lady who is with them. This editorial is exclusively for women.

Ladies: the Courier wishes at this time to remind you that before it makes its next appearance there will be an election in the county seat, at which a mayor and some councilmen are to be chosen. There are also some questions of general interest on the ballot. And you, ladies, have the right of going to the polls and voting.

The Courier hopes you will go, and that you will carefully mark your ballot as your conscience dictates. The people who will be elected to office,

the sudden redressing of Fifth street was under discussion, Mr. Templeton might have done lots for the city if he had probed and questioned, but never a peep was there then from his lips. Yet now, with only the explanation that he had "heard" something was the matter with the Fallsview job, he leaps to his feet in open council meeting and discharges abrupt interrogations at the city engineer.

Wonder if Mr. Templeton never "heard" anything about Fifth street?

And there was one item on the bill of fare thus universally served that sheds some light on Oregon as an apple-raising section. That item, to be found in all the government menus, is "North Yakima apples." Probably there were reasons for the selection of Yakima apples for Uncle Sam's boys.

And probably there will go up a wall from Hood and Rogue river communities, too—just as there was a wall over the worm at San Francisco. But wailing will not accomplish the desired result—the only way to make the Oregon apple supreme is to grow the best apple in the world. Until then there will be the need of worms for alibis, and until Oregon apples are the equal of other apples, Uncle Sam will continue to serve Washington apples on state occasions.

And this reminds us that some years ago when the Portland Y. M. C. A. gave a dinner to Portland newspapermen, they served Wenatchee apples. Evidently there is something more than a single worm in Oregon apples, and the condition ought to be changed.